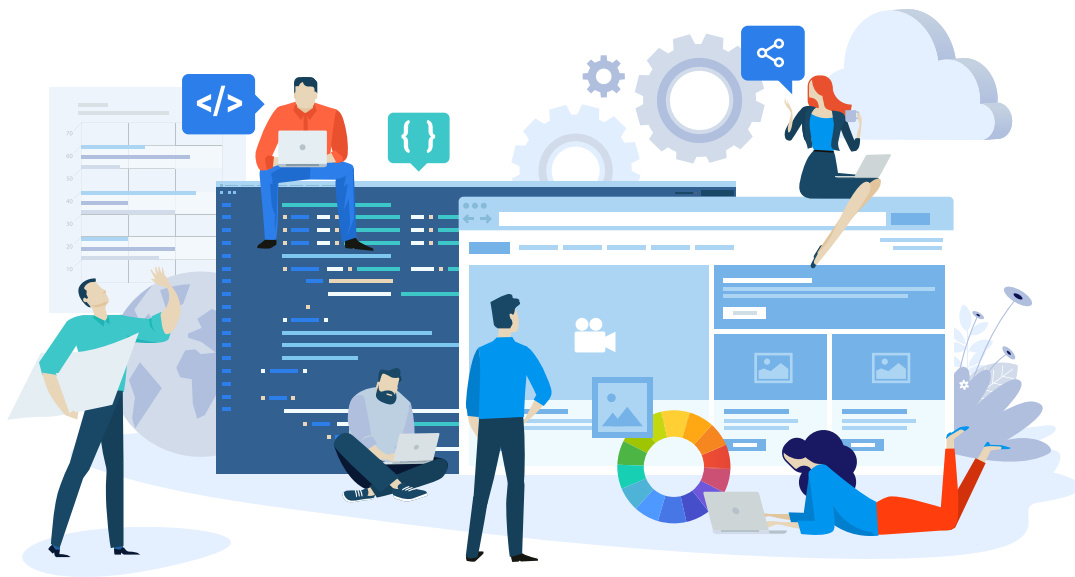


# Best Practices to Make a Lean Software Product

The seven principles of lean software development provide a toolkit that can ensure more software functionality delivered in substantially less time, elimination of all unnecessary activities, cost reductions, while also inducing lateral thinking and enabling team empowerment.



**L**ean software development is an agile framework that focuses on optimising time and resources. The lean approach is more like natural selection, where one of the many designed products is chosen and developed through trials and customer feedback. The process of creating a minimum viable product (MVP) can be streamlined using lean principles, which focus on the rapid development process while ruthlessly cutting away any activity, feature or resource that might not affect the final product.

## Minimum viable product

The idea of an MVP is that you should develop an actual product or service (which can be no more than a landing

page — a service with an appearance of automation, but which is completely manual behind the scenes) that you can offer to customers and observe their actual behaviour with it. Learning from what people actually do with respect to a product is much more reliable than asking people what they would do. The main benefit of an MVP is that you can learn about your customers' interest in your product without fully developing the product. This encourages teams to do the least amount of work possible for useful feedback. It helps them to avoid working on products that have not received good feedback. This is complementary to two other principles of lean software development — eliminate waste, and deliver as fast as possible

## History

What happens when an automotive giant faces a product development problem that can incur the company huge loss when every penny matters? The answer is lean product development. In the 20th century, the famous Japanese motor company Toyota was faced with a daunting challenge of making its product delivery more efficient, a giant task that was not easy to perform by only using existing product management strategies. The product manager came up with a new management technique which, in essence, was to eliminate all waste that one might face during production.

In 2003, lean manufacturing was being closely studied by different industries including the IT industry. At